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Personal Hygiene, Sickness & Protective Clothing			
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1.0 PURPOSE

The purpose of this Standard Operating Procedure is to describe the overall process for ensuring personnel compliance with Good Manufacturing Practice, Health & Safety and the prevention of product contamination from personnel contact.

2.0 SCOPE

Departments, Job Functions	This SOP applies to all Supplement Factory employees and contractors in the Ashford Manufacturing Sites. NB Visitors must comply with the requirements of SOP 1.02 Visitors Policy
Limitations	This SOP does not apply to third party manufacturing sites. This SOP does not apply to any operations carried out before the effective date of this procedure.

3.0 DELEGATION OF ACTIVITIES

Delegation	Responsible parties in the procedure may delegate an activity but retain responsibility for the outcome. Delegation can only be made to personnel who have been appropriately trained.
	Activities delegated to external contractors must be documented in a contract.

4.0 PROCEDURE

4.1. PERSONAL HYGIENE REQUIREMENTS, CLOTHING AND COSMETICS POLICY

	Responsibility	Instruction
4.1.1	Managers	All employees must receive hygiene training including training in hand washing techniques.
4.1.2	All staff	It is a requirement that all staff practice good sanitation and health habits, including coming to the site in clean clothing and shoes.
4.1.3	All staff	Clothes must be made from non-fuzzy material (i.e. not prone to losing fluff or fabric). Short clothing is not permitted, legs and waist must be covered. Clothing must be free from hairs including pet hair and dead skin including dandruff.
4.1.4	All staff	Open-toed sandals or shoes or clogs are not permitted in the GMP areas.
4.1.5	All staff	Before coming on site minimise odour and perspiration by washing and applying an effective anti-perspiration product. Whilst on site any perspiration liable to drip onto product, components or product-contact surfaces must be controlled.

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4.1.6	All staff	Production staff must not wear nail varnish (nail art), or excessive cosmetics (including fragrance) on site.
4.1.7	All staff	Fingernails must be kept trimmed and clean. False fingernails are not permitted.
4.1.8	All staff	Spitting is strictly prohibited and is not tolerated in any area of the site.
4.1.9	All staff	No pets or animals of any kind are permitted on site including car park and grounds.

4.2. HEALTH & SICKNESS

4.2.1	All staff	Health conditions that could be a source of microbial contamination must be reported to Management before the employee enters the production facility. Health conditions that could be a source of microbial contamination include: (but are not limited to) • Cold or flu symptoms such as sneezing and coughing • Fever • Vomiting • Communicable diseases should as measles, mumps and chickenpox • Significant stomach upsets and diarrhea • Skin infections • Cuts, wounds or open lesions. This includes new tattoos which must be covered for the first three weeks as a minimum. • Burns, boils or sores All staff (include office staff) must also report any known symptoms relating to global / localised pandemics prior to entering any sites. Instructions will be communicated with all staff when information is made available and these instructions must be strictly followed. Communication may be made available via emails, letters or verbal communication.
4.2.2	All staff	Management must decide as to whether an employee should be excluded from the operation/site or if protective measures can be taken such as plasters and gloves to cover cuts and wounds. Face masks are also available as a protective measure against minor infections. Staff may also be transferred to lower risk operations or to be asked to work from home where able to.

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4.2.3	All staff	If any symptoms start to develop or if a medical condition changes whilst an employee is at work then management must be informed immediately and a decision made on the employee's situation. If the employee is excluded from work then the normal return to work procedure applies ensuring the employee's fitness to resume.
4.2.4	All staff	If any symptoms develop after returning from visiting a tropical country management must be notified.
4.2.5.	All staff	Employees who fail to notify management of relevant medical conditions will be subject to disciplinary proceedings.
4.2.6	All staff	Management should always be vigilant and act immediately on instances where employees and visitors start to exhibit symptoms of illness and infection. Necessary deviations and risk assessments should be documented.
4.2.7	Management	During the recruitment process for new employees, it must be established if the applicant has any pre-existing health conditions that could be potential sources of microbial contamination to product, components or product contact surfaces.
4.2.8	All staff	New employees must declare any pre-existing health conditions as part of their induction.
4.2.9	All staff	Any accidents that occur on site must be dealt with according to first aid procedures. They must be handled appropriately to minimise the risk of contamination to the product.
4.2.10	Management	If the accident involves broken skin, bleeding or vomiting or any other spillage of bodily fluids in the production area then production must be halted immediately. This must be recorded as a deviation subject to risk assessment. NB only approved 'blue' food safe plasters may be used.
4.2.11	Management	Wherever the accident occurs the risk of physical and microbial contamination to product, components, and product contact surfaces in the vicinity of the accident must be considered. If necessary any affected product or materials must be quarantined and affected surfaces, equipment or utensils thoroughly cleaned and sanitized before production or activities such as loading or unloading can continue. This must be logged as a deviation and any necessary risk assessments completed.

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4.3. DRESS CODE

4.3.1	All staff	Coats or overalls assigned to employees and visitors must be visually clean and correctly closed at the front with sleeves rolled down to cover the arms. Coats must have no external pockets. Nothing should be clipped or appended to the coats including pens, badges, thermometers, etc.
4.3.2	All staff	Dirty coats must be placed in the appropriate locker for cleaning which must take place on a regular basis.
4.3.3	All staff	Clean hairnets must be worn correctly to cover all the hair and to cover all the ears. Hair Net Guides are situated in changing rooms; Red – Managers & Office staff Yellow – Team Leaders Blue – Operators, Agency and Visitors White – Engineers Green - First Aiders
4.3.4	All staff	Face masks covering mouth and nose must be worn in the production area by all staff and visitors. If there is difficulty purchasing face masks, an assessment must be made to consider the risks of areas where appropriate to wear them and technical must be made aware of the shortage to make an informed decision. For example, if there is a shortage of face masks, they must be worn in product contact areas and other areas may be risk assessed. When dust masks are required as PPE for health & safety requirements the face mask is not required.
4.3.5	All staff	Unless clean shaven, beard snoods must be worn correctly to cover all visible facial stubble, goatees, beard and moustache. This is in addition to the face mask.
4.3.6	All staff	Gloves are provided and must be worn when handling product, primary components or product contact surfaces (e.g. filling change parts). If necessary, disposable sleeves must also be worn to ensure any gaps between coat sleeves and gloves are covered.
4.3.7	All staff	Gloves must be worn correctly on each hand and replaced when damaged, soiled or contaminated. They must be made from sanitary materials such as vinyl or latex. Fabric gloves may only be worn under the sanitary gloves to ensure no shedding of material.

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4.3.8	All staff	Safety shoes must be visibly clean and in a fit state. The safety shoes used in the production area must not leave the facility and must be stored in the changing room. The safety shoes used in the warehouse must not be taken home at night.
4.3.8	All staff	Overshoes must be worn over external shoes by visitors within the production areas. They must cover the whole shoe and be replaced if worn. Use of overshoes does not allow the wearing of dirty shoes within the facility.
4.3.9	Dress code for Production	
4.3.9.1	All staff	Correctly worn hairnets, face masks, white coats or overalls and beard snood if facial hair is visible. When leaving the production area the coat or overall must be removed and hung in the changing room and the hairnet, face mask and beard snood discarded and placed in the bin. Production coats or overalls must not be worn outside the production area or changing room. Red disposable coats are worn when handling allergens see SOP 5.19 Allergen Control
4.3.9.2	All staff	Safety shoes which are designated specifically for the production area must be worn. When leaving the production area shoes must be removed and stored in the designated storage location in the changing room. If not going outside or if leaving production for a short period e.g. toilet break then overshoes can be worn over safety shoes. Employees waiting for safety shoes or visitors must wear overshoes over their own shoes ensuring they are replaced as necessary.
4.3.10.4	All staff	When directly handling the product e.g. capsules, powders, or handling or touching primary components e.g. pots, lids, or equipment, utensils or product contact surfaces, gloves must be worn and disposed of in the general refuse bin immediately after use. If necessary, disposable sleeves must also be worn to ensure any gaps between coat sleeves and gloves are covered.
4.3.10.5	All staff	Personnel must wear dust masks when required as PPE for health & safety requirements. Face masks do not need to be worn with dust masks.
4.3.10.6	All staff	Protective clothing must be changed at an appropriate frequency. It also includes if they are dirty or if allergenic material has been used. The appropriate allergenic coats must be worn if handling allergenic materials.
4.3.11	Dress code for warehouse	

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4.3.11.1	All staff	Clean and appropriate clothing must be worn in the warehouse or yard area including high visibility jackets and protective hats where indicated.
4.3.11.2	All staff	Staff directly handling or sampling exposed material or product must wear approved production gloves.
4.3.11.3	All staff	Due to the elevated temperatures experienced in the warehouse during warmer months, warehouse operatives are permitted to wear shorts, provided the following conditions are met: Design & Condition - Shorts must be knee-length, clean, and company-approved. - No frayed, ripped, or excessively short garments are permitted. - Shorts must be made of durable material suitable for manual work. Footwear & PPE - Approved safety footwear and any required PPE (e.g. high-visibility vests, gloves) must be worn at all times. - Shorts must not compromise the effectiveness of any PPE. Area Restriction - Shorts are only permitted in warehouse areas where no open product or ingredient handling takes place. - Entry to production, blending, packing, or high-care areas in shorts is strictly prohibited. Hygiene Standards - All other personal hygiene requirements remain in force, including clean clothing, hand hygiene, and absence of external jewellery. Risk Assessment - A documented risk assessment has been conducted confirming that wearing shorts in the warehouse does not pose a product contamination risk under current operations.

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4.4. JEWELLERY, MOBILE PHONE AND PERSONAL ITEMS

4.4.1	All staff	All jewellery must be removed prior to starting work and stored in a locker or other secure place. Wherever possible all jewellery must be left at home and not brought on site. No jewellery of any type is allowed in the production and warehouse areas.
4.4.2	All staff	Jewellery includes (but is not limited to) the following items: • Finger rings • Ear-rings • All body and facial piercings • Necklaces, pendants or chains • Bracelets, watches or other forms of wrist jewellery • Hair pins, curlers or ribbons • Stones or decorations glued to nails or other parts of the body.
4.4.3	All staff	If anyone has a ring which management agree is too tight to remove then the hand must be covered at all times with an approved glove. The glove must be changed regularly to keep it in a clean and sanitary condition.
4.4.4	All staff	Watches are not permitted within the production area and must be stored in a locker or other secure location before entering the area.
4.4.5	All staff	Mobile phones should not be taken into production or warehouse areas unless authorised by Production or Warehouse Management. Phones must be kept enclosed in pockets. Mobile phones may not be used in Production or Warehouse areas except for the changing room if absolutely necessary.
4.4.6	All Staff	If any production staff have a requirement for daily medication then these must not be taken into production areas but instead, must be stored in the operators designated locker for safe storage, to prevent any risk of contamination of product or food contact surfaces.

4.5. FOOD AND DRINK POLICY

4.5.1	All staff	Preparing, storing, eating, drinking, consuming and chewing any food, drink, supplement or medicinal product is strictly prohibited in all production and warehouse areas.
4.5.2	All staff	Food and drink may only be stored in kitchen and office areas and must not be stored in the changing room or lockers.

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4.5.3	All staff	All work wear (coats, hats, gloves) must be removed before preparing or consuming food, drink, supplements or medicinal products.
4.5.4	All staff	Clear and clean up immediately after preparing or consuming food and drink. Hands must be thoroughly washed afterwards before returning to work according to the company hand wash procedure.
4.5.5	All staff	The use of chewing gum, bubble gum, sweets and all other related products are strictly forbidden in warehouse and production areas.

4.6. TOBACCO AND SMOKING PRODUCTS

4.6.1	All staff	Smoking and the use and preparation of all tobacco products is strictly prohibited in all buildings. Electronic cigarettes and vaping devices are also prohibited in all buildings. Smoking, electronic cigarettes, vaping devices and the use and preparation of all tobacco products is only allowed off site or in authorised designated areas.
4.6.2	All staff	Breaks for smoking or the use of tobacco products must be authorised by management. All work wear as outlined in the dress code policy above must be removed. On return to work, work wear must be put on and hands washed thoroughly according to the hand wash policy.
4.6.3	All staff	Smokers are responsible for clearing up all wastage following the preparation or usage of smoking or other tobacco products and for their disposal in a suitable area.

4.7. ALLERGENS

4.7.1	All staff	Allergen Control is discussed in detail in SOP 5.19. All staff need to be aware of the risk of bring allergens on site or having contact with allergens off site.
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4.7.2	All staff	The top UK food allergens are: • celery • cereals containing gluten – including wheat, rye, barley and oats • crustaceans – such as prawns, crabs and lobsters • eggs • fish • lupin • milk • molluscs – such as mussels and oysters • mustard • tree nuts – including almonds, hazelnuts, walnuts, brazil nuts, cashews, pecans, pistachios and macadamia nuts • peanuts • sesame seeds • soybeans • sulphur dioxide and sulphites (if they are at a concentration of more than ten parts per million) Examples of other allergenic materials are cat hair, dog hair etc.
4.7.3	All staff	Only approved raw materials may be taken into production or warehouse areas. Other allergen materials e.g. foods, snacks are strictly banned from these areas.
4.7.4.	All staff	Prior to a work day or during a work day staff must minimise all contact with allergenic materials. Clothes that have been in contact with allergens should not be worn in a production or warehouse area. There must be special attention to handwashing after handling any allergenic material.

4.8. PROCEDURE FOR ENTERING PRODUCTION AND HAND WASHING POLICY.

4.8.1	All staff	When entering the production areas SOP 1.03 must be followed.
4.8.2	All staff	No personal belongings are allowed in the production area and must be stored in a locker or other secure area on arrival. This includes coats, mobile phones (unless authorized), cameras, MP3 players all portable devices, tobacco products. Wallets and keys may be kept in a secure trouser pocket below waist level.
4.8.3.	All staff	No food or drink items are allowed to be taken into the production areas and must be stored in designated kitchen or office areas.
4.8.4	All staff	No items must be stored on top of a locker.

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4.8.5	All staff	Hands must be washed thoroughly with warm water and antibacterial soap followed by treatment with antibacterial gel before entering production.
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5.0 REVISION HISTORY

01	New procedure. Training is required
02	Addition of guidance on mobile phones and allergens
03	Additional references and general update.
04	Update to state no electronic cigarettes to be used on site & nail art shall not be permitted.
05	General update following 2 year review & addition of requirement to wear face masks in all production areas.
06	Updated to require use of disposable sleeves when necessary.4.3.6, 4.3.10.4
07	Additional points regarding pandemic
08	Addition of tattoo (4.2.1) & enhanced pandemic requirements (4.9)
09	Addition of hair net guide.
10	Update to 4.4.1 following BRC audit.
11	2 year review – no changes
12	Revisions to section 4.3.11 to cover warehouse personnel wearing shorts
13	Update to remove covid 19 pandemic requirements

6.0 REFERENCES

6.1.	Regulatory References
	21 CFR 111 BRCGS Section 7
6.2.	Associated Documents
	SOP 1.02 Visitors policy SOP 1.03 Production changing procedure SOP 1.06 Hand Washing Procedure SOP 1.09 Control of Blue Plasters SOP 1.11 Return to Work SOP 5.19 Allergen Control

7.0 DISTRIBUTION LIST

All staff
Technical File

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8.0 APPENDICES

8.1	Appendix 1: Competency test
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APPENDIX 1: COMPETENCY TEST

Full training of this SOP requires successful completion of the following competency test

1. Question 1: Health conditions that could be a source of microbial contamination must be:

- a. Covered b. Reported to c. Assumed to be OK
management

2. Question 2: Before entering productions areas you must: (ring all that apply)

- a. Wash hands b. Use antibacterial c. Remove all jewellery
gel

3. Question 3: If you have a ring that you cannot remove you must:

- a. Not use that hand b. Wear approved c. Wash it well with
to touch anything glove approved antibacterial
soap

PASS MARK = 100%

It will not always be necessary for this assessment to occur if the individual has successfully been performing this task within Forza and according to the standards required in this SOP for more than 6 months. This should be justified and noted in the training record.

Name of Trainee:		
Competency test (delete as appropriate):	Pass	Fail
On the job assessment (if applicable)(delete as appropriate):	Pass	Fail
Signed by Trainee:	Date:	
Signed by Trainer:	Date:	

The signatures above denote successful completion of training. This must be recorded in the individual's training record by the trainer.

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